# VAI - Vehicle Accountability Index

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

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# 1. Executive Summary

VAI (Vehicle Accountability Index) is a web-based platform that consolidates an individual's traffic challan history, challan payment behaviour and vehicle compliance records into a single score between 500 and 900. The model is modelled on the way a credit bureau scores financial discipline: every registered individual starts at 700, and the score moves up or down as responsible or irresponsible driving behaviour is observed over time.

The platform's purpose goes beyond scoring. Individuals in the Good and Very Good categories become eligible for discounts on vehicle insurance premiums, PUC renewals, RC renewals and driving licence renewals. Where the scheme is government-approved, the discount is funded by the sponsor, not by the user. VAI earns a small platform fee of 0.005% to 0.010% on each successfully processed transaction, and that fee is shown separately in every transaction breakdown.

This PRD defines what VAI does, for whom, and why. It sets out the functional and non-functional requirements, the scoring methodology at product level, the reward and fee logic, the prototype dataset, the roadmap and the risks. The companion TRD defines the architecture, data model, API contracts and exact formulas needed to build it.

The first deliverable is a fully working prototype that runs entirely on fictional data. It uses simulated OTP authentication and simulated payments, and it has no connection to VAHAN, Parivahan, eChallan, insurers or payment gateways. Those integrations are a later phase and depend on API access, authorization and regulatory approval.

# 2. Problem Statement

Vehicle compliance in India is fragmented. Challans are issued through one channel, insurance and PUC certificates are renewed through another, and RC and licence renewals run on separate portals. An individual rarely has a single view of where they stand. As a result, unpaid challans accumulate unnoticed, document expiries are missed, and renewals are often done at the last minute at the highest cost.

The system also gives almost no positive reinforcement. Penalties arrive, but a driver with ten years of clean records receives no recognition, no lower premium and no visible benefit. Nothing in the current ecosystem rewards sustained good behaviour, so the incentive to drive responsibly is weak.

VAI addresses both gaps. It gives each person one transparent score that reflects their full record, and it converts that score into tangible savings on the renewals they already have to make.

# 3. Product Vision and Objectives

Vision statement: every responsible driver in India should have a visible, portable record of their compliance, and that record should earn them measurable savings on the services they already need.

## 3.1 Business and Product Objectives

| Objective | What success looks like |
|---|---|
| Reduce unpaid and late challans | Measurable increase in on-time challan payments among VAI users |
| Reward responsible driving | Share of users in Good or Very Good categories rises over time |
| Simplify vehicle renewals | Insurance, PUC, RC and licence renewals completed in one flow |
| Build a sustainable revenue stream | Platform fee revenue grows in line with processed transaction volume |
| Keep the system transparent | Every score change is explained to the user and recorded in a ledger |
| Protect personal data | PAN is never stored or displayed in plain text; consent is recorded |

# 4. Target Users and Personas

VAI has three primary user groups and one internal group. Each has different needs, and the design must serve all of them without making the citizen experience complicated.

| Persona | Profile | Needs | Pain points today |
|---|---|---|---|
| Priya, salaried commuter | Owns one two-wheeler and one car; 34 years old; uses a phone for most tasks | Lower insurance premium; one place to see challans; quick renewal reminders | Surprised by unpaid challans; pays insurance at full price every year |
| Rahul, small fleet owner | Operates three commercial vehicles for a logistics business | Compliance status for every vehicle in one view; bulk renewal visibility | Tracks documents in spreadsheets; expired PUC causes downtime |
| Anita, senior driver | Drives occasionally; limited comfort with complex apps | Simple login; clear wording; large text; plain-language explanations | Confused by multi-step portals; unsure what a challan means |
| Admin, VAI operations | Internal team running the platform and reports | Configure scoring and reward rules; monitor revenue and data quality; audit trail | No single tool to see score distribution or transaction health |

# 5. Scope

The prototype covers the complete user experience using dummy data and simulated services. The production scope adds live integrations once approvals are in place.

| Area | Prototype (Phase 1) | Production (later phases) |
|---|---|---|
| Authentication | Mobile number and PAN with simulated OTP | Real SMS OTP via DLT-registered provider; consent manager |
| Data source | 10 or more fictional user datasets | VAHAN, Parivahan, eChallan via authorized APIs |
| Scoring | Full engine, ledger and history on dummy data | Same engine, tuned on real anonymised data |
| Rewards | Calculated and displayed; discount funded in simulation | Live sponsor funding with approved schemes |
| Services | Simulated insurance, PUC, RC and licence renewal | Live insurer, PUC centre and RTO integrations |
| Payments | Simulated payment and receipt | Licensed payment gateway, settlement and refunds |
| Admin | Full admin dashboard on dummy data | Role management, regulator reporting, live monitoring |

# 6. Functional Requirements

Priority uses the MoSCoW scale: M means must have, S means should have, C means could have. Every functional requirement below is traceable to a user story in Section 10 and to a technical component in the TRD.

## 6.1 Authentication and Access

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| FR-A1 | The login page accepts a registered mobile number and a PAN, validates both formats, and requests an OTP. | M |
| FR-A2 | The system sends a six-digit OTP (simulated in the prototype) that expires after five minutes and allows three attempts. | M |
| FR-A3 | After successful OTP verification, the system retrieves all vehicles linked to that mobile number and PAN. | M |
| FR-A4 | The user is redirected to a personalised dashboard; sessions expire after 15 minutes of inactivity. | M |
| FR-A5 | PAN is shown only in masked form (last four characters visible) everywhere in the interface. | M |
| FR-A6 | The user can log out, and all session tokens are invalidated on logout. | M |
| FR-A7 | The admin panel uses a separate login with role-based permissions and mandatory second factor in production. | M |

## 6.2 Dashboard and Score Display

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| FR-D1 | Dashboard greets the user by name and shows the current VAI Score, category and a circular score meter. | M |
| FR-D2 | Dashboard shows total vehicles, total challans, paid challans, pending challans and overall vehicle compliance status. | M |
| FR-D3 | Dashboard shows previous month's score, the change since then, the top reasons for change, and the next score milestone. | M |
| FR-D4 | Dashboard shows the rewards the user currently qualifies for and the discount percentage for each service. | M |
| FR-D5 | Each score change is listed with its reason code, date, points changed and running balance. | M |
| FR-D6 | Score history chart shows the trend over the last 12 months. | S |

## 6.3 Vehicle and Challan Management

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| FR-V1 | Vehicle list shows registration number, type, brand, model and status badges for insurance, PUC and RC. | M |
| FR-V2 | Selecting a vehicle opens its detail page with document expiry dates, days remaining and vehicle-specific challan history. | M |
| FR-V3 | Challan table supports filter by status (Paid, Unpaid, Pending), severity and date range, and sorting by any column. | M |
| FR-V4 | Challans marked Disputed or Pending are visibly flagged and are excluded from score calculation until resolved. | M |
| FR-V5 | Vehicle compliance score and the individual VAI Score are displayed separately and never merged in the UI. | S |

## 6.4 Rewards, Services and Transactions

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| FR-R1 | Rewards page lists each service with the discount percentage for each VAI category. | M |
| FR-R2 | Service flow: select vehicle, retrieve details, calculate amount, apply discount, calculate platform fee, show final payable, simulate payment, generate receipt. | M |
| FR-R3 | Price breakdown displays original amount, discount percentage, government-funded benefit, user payable amount and platform fee separately. | M |
| FR-R4 | Simulated payment supports success, failure and timeout outcomes, selectable for testing. | M |
| FR-R5 | Each completed transaction produces a downloadable receipt with a unique transaction ID. | M |
| FR-R6 | Transaction history lists all past transactions with status and a refund action for admins. | S |

### 6.5 Admin

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| FR-M1 | Admin can view, search and filter users, vehicles and challans. | M |
| FR-M2 | Admin can edit scoring parameters, reward percentages and fee options, with effective dates. | M |
| FR-M3 | Every configuration change is written to an audit log with the old value, new value, admin identity and timestamp. | M |
| FR-M4 | Admin dashboard shows score distribution across categories, revenue by fee option and transaction success rate. | M |
| FR-M5 | Admin can reset or regenerate the dummy datasets from a single control. | M |
| FR-M6 | Admin can export reports as CSV and PDF. | S |

## 7. VAI Scoring Methodology

The scoring model is proprietary, but its principles must be transparent to users. A user who sees their score fall should be able to name the reason and understand how to recover. The TRD (Section 9) gives the exact formulas, weights and caps. This section explains the product logic.

### 7.1 Design Principles

The score starts at 700 for every new user. It can never go above 900 or below 500. A single violation does not destroy a score, because the model is designed so that one mistake is recoverable. Older violations lose influence gradually, using a half-life of one year, so the score reflects recent behaviour more than distant history. Disputed or pending challans do not count as violations until they are resolved. Monthly movement is capped at 50 points, so the score cannot swing wildly from one bad week.

### 7.2 Scoring Factors

| Factor | What it measures | Direction |
|---|---|---|
| Violation penalty | Confirmed violations weighted by severity (Low, Medium, High) and reduced by age | Negative |
| Repeat penalty | Same category of violation repeated within 12 months | Negative |
| Payment behaviour | Challans paid on time, challans unpaid after the due date | Positive or negative |
| Driving discipline | Consecutive violation-free days at 30, 90 and 180 day milestones | Positive |
| Vehicle and licence compliance | Valid or expired insurance, PUC, RC and driving licence | Positive or negative |

### 7.3 Categories and Benefits

| Score range | Category | Visual treatment | Reward eligibility |
|---|---|---|---|
| 500 to 649 | Fair | Amber meter | No discount |
| 650 to 749 | Good | Teal meter | 1% discount on eligible services |
| 750 to 900 | Very Good | Green meter with highlight badge | 2% discount on eligible services |

### 7.4 Worked Example

Consider a user with three confirmed challans in the last year: two Low severity challans issued 200 and 300 days ago, and one Medium severity challan issued 60 days ago. All three were paid on time. The user has been violation-free for 60 days, has one vehicle with valid insurance, PUC and RC, and a valid licence. The age-decayed violation penalty is about 19.6 points. Three on-time payments add 9 points. The 60-day streak adds 10 points. Full vehicle compliance adds 15 points. The score is therefore approximately 714, which places the user in the Good category. The next milestone at 750 requires another 36 points, which a clean 90-day streak and continued compliance would deliver.

The figures above are illustrative. The exact formula, with all weights and caps, is in TRD Section 9.

### 7.5 Transparency Commitments

Every score change is recorded in a score ledger with an event type, a points value, a reason code and a reference to the source record such as a challan ID. Users can see the ledger in the app. The app also offers a plain-language explanation for each change, written for a non-technical reader.

## 8. Rewards and Monetization Model

### 8.1 Reward Structure

Discounts apply to four services based on the user's VAI category at the time of checkout. The percentages below are proposed benefits. They must be configurable, and the final values depend on the government-approved scheme and on the agreements with participating service providers.

| Service | Fair | Good | Very Good |
|---|---|---|---|
| Vehicle insurance premium | No discount | 1% | 2% |
| PUC renewal | No discount | 1% | 2% |
| RC renewal | No discount | 1% | 2% |
| Driving licence renewal | No discount | 1% | 2% |

### 8.2 Reward Calculation Logic

When a user selects a service, the platform performs six steps. It retrieves the current VAI Score, identifies the reward category, calculates the discount on the original service amount, shows the government-funded benefit where the scheme is authorised, calculates the amount payable by the user, and shows the platform fee in a separate line. Every figure is displayed so the user can verify it.

Worked example. Vehicle insurance premium is Rs. 10,000. The user is in the Very Good category, so the discount is 2%. The government-funded benefit is Rs. 200. The user pays Rs. 9,800. The platform fee is calculated on the Rs. 10,000 base and is charged to the provider, not added to the user's payable amount, unless the admin switches the fee to pass-through mode.

### 8.3 Platform Fee Structure

| Fee option | Rate | Fee on Rs. 10,000 | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| Option A | 0.005% per transaction | Rs. 0.50 | Lower rate, used for high-volume services |
| Option B | 0.010% per transaction | Rs. 1.00 | Higher rate, used for premium or low-volume services |

The fee base is the original service amount before any discount, so the platform's revenue does not depend on how generous the reward is. The admin selects the active option, and changes take effect on a stated date. Refunds reverse the fee proportionally and are recorded in the transaction log.

### 8.4 Revenue Streams

Revenue comes from the platform transaction fee in Phase 1. Later phases may add a listing fee for service providers who want priority placement in the services section, and a data analytics product for insurers and fleet operators that uses anonymised and aggregated data with consent. Advertising is out of scope, because it would compromise the neutrality of the scoring system.

## 9. User Journeys

Four journeys define the core product experience. Each journey is written from the user's point of view, and the system response is described at a level the product team can verify.

### 9.1 First-Time Login and Dashboard

| Step | User action | System response |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Opens the landing page and enters mobile number and PAN | Validates formats; masks PAN as it is typed |
| 2 | Taps Get OTP | Sends a simulated OTP; displays a countdown of five minutes |
| 3 | Enters the six-digit OTP | Verifies the OTP; locks after three failed attempts |
| 4 | Lands on the dashboard | Loads all linked vehicles, the current score, the category and the reward status |
| 5 | Reads the score explanation | Shows the top three factors affecting the score in plain language |

### 9.2 Checking Score and Challans

| Step | User action | System response |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Opens the Score page | Shows the circular meter, category, previous month comparison and milestone |
| 2 | Opens the score ledger | Lists every change with date, reason and running balance |
| 3 | Selects a vehicle | Shows the vehicle's documents and its challan history separately from the personal score |
| 4 | Filters challans to Unpaid | Lists unpaid challans and the date each became overdue |

### 9.3 Renewing Vehicle Insurance

| Step | User action | System response |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Opens Services and selects Vehicle Insurance Renewal | Lists the user's vehicles and the insurance expiry date for each |
| 2 | Selects a vehicle | Retrieves the vehicle details and the simulated premium quote |
| 3 | Reviews the price breakdown | Shows original amount, discount, government benefit, payable amount and platform fee |
| 4 | Confirms and pays | Simulates payment; shows success, failure or timeout as selected |
| 5 | Downloads the receipt | Generates a receipt with transaction ID and updates the vehicle's insurance status |

### 9.4 Reviewing a Disputed Challan

| Step | User action | System response |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Opens a challan marked Pending | Shows that the challan is excluded from scoring until resolved |
| 2 | Raises a dispute | Changes the status to Disputed and records a timestamped note |
| 3 | Waits for resolution | On resolution by an admin, the status updates and the score is recalculated |

## 10. User Stories

Stories are written in the standard format. Acceptance criteria for each story appear in the TRD test plan (Section 15).

| ID | As a | I want to | So that |
|---|---|---|---|
| US-01 | citizen | log in with my mobile number and PAN and an OTP | I can access my records securely |
| US-02 | citizen | see my VAI Score and what changed it | I know how to improve it |
| US-03 | citizen | see all vehicles linked to me | I can track their compliance in one place |
| US-04 | citizen | filter my challans by status | I can find and pay the unpaid ones quickly |
| US-05 | citizen | see my discount before I pay | I know exactly what I will save |
| US-06 | citizen | renew my insurance through VAI | I get my discount without visiting several portals |
| US-07 | citizen | download a receipt for each transaction | I have proof for my records |
| US-08 | fleet owner | see compliance status for every vehicle | I can avoid downtime from expired documents |
| US-09 | senior citizen | use large, plain-language screens | I can complete renewals without help |
| US-10 | admin | change scoring weights with an effective date | the model can be tuned without a code release |
| US-11 | admin | see every configuration change in an audit log | changes are accountable |
| US-12 | admin | reset the dummy dataset | I can demonstrate different user profiles quickly |

## 11. Prototype Dataset Overview

The prototype ships with ten fictional user accounts. Each profile is designed to show a different driving behaviour and a different part of the scoring model. All PAN values follow the dummy pattern DUMMY1001X to DUMMY1010X, and all mobile numbers are in a reserved dummy range. None of them relate to a real person. The TRD (Section 18) defines the generation rules and the full field list.

| ID | Profile | What it demonstrates |
|---|---|---|
| U001 | Zero challans | Baseline score of 700 with full vehicle compliance, showing the Good category |
| U002 | Occasional minor violations | Small deductions that decay over time and are offset by payments |
| U003 | Frequent violations | Repeat penalty engaged; score in the Fair category |

| ID | Profile | What it demonstrates |
|---|---|---|
| U004 | Serious violations | High severity deductions and a slower recovery curve |
| U005 | Unpaid challans | Overdue penalties activated after the due date |
| U006 | Excellent discipline over 12 months | Streak bonus at 180 days; Very Good category |
| U007 | Commercial fleet with three vehicles | Vehicle compliance averaged across fleet; mixed document status |
| U008 | New registration | Starts at 700 with no history and an explanation of the starting point |
| U009 | Expired documents | Insurance and PUC expired; vehicle compliance penalty applied |
| U010 | Disputed and pending challans | Excluded from scoring until resolved; flagged in the UI |

# 12. Non-Functional Requirements

| Category | Requirement |
|---|---|
| Responsiveness | Fully usable on desktop, tablet and mobile; layouts tested at 360px, 768px and 1280px widths |
| Performance | Dashboard loads in under 2 seconds on a 4G connection; API p95 response under 300 ms for reads |
| Availability | Prototype: best effort. Production target 99.5% monthly uptime, excluding planned maintenance |
| Security | PAN encrypted at rest and masked in display; OTP rate limited; role-based access control |
| Privacy | Consent captured before data is shown; data minimisation applied; compliance with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 |
| Accessibility | WCAG 2.1 AA; minimum 16px body text; keyboard navigation; colour is never the only signal |
| Auditability | All score and configuration changes are logged and cannot be edited or deleted by any role |
| Localisation | English in Phase 1; Hindi and Gujarati in Phase 2 for wider reach |
| Browser support | Latest two versions of Chrome, Edge, Firefox and Safari; Android and iOS browsers |

# 13. Feature Prioritization

The MoSCoW classification below governs the prototype backlog. Must have items are required for the demonstration; should have items are included if time allows; could have items are deferred.

| Category | Must have | Should have | Could have |
|---|---|---|---|
| Authentication | Mobile and PAN login, simulated OTP, masking | Session timeout warnings | Biometric login |
| Dashboard | Score meter, category, challan counts, rewards | 12-month score chart | Personalised tips feed |
| Vehicles and challans | Vehicle list, detail, challan filters | Document reminders | Photo-based challan lookup |
| Scoring | Full engine, ledger, decay, caps | Scenario simulator for users | Machine learning risk model |
| Rewards and services | Four renewal flows, price breakdown, fee | Provider comparison | Loyalty points |
| Admin | User, vehicle and challan views; config with audit | CSV and PDF exports | Live monitoring alerts |

# 14. Admin Requirements

| Area | Capabilities |
|---|---|
| User management | View, search and filter users; view masked PAN; view a user's score ledger |
| Vehicle management | View vehicles and document status; flag records for review |
| Challan monitoring | View challans by status and severity; resolve disputes; trigger recalculation |
| Score analytics | Distribution across categories; trend over time; users changed in the last 30 days |
| Scoring configuration | Edit weights, caps and decay half-life with an effective date and a preview of impact |
| Reward configuration | Edit discount percentages per category and service; set effective dates |
| Fee configuration | Select Option A or Option B; set pass-through or provider-paid mode |
| Transactions | Monitor status; issue refunds; view revenue by service and fee option |
| Dataset management | Reset or regenerate the ten dummy profiles |
| Audit logs | Search by actor, entity and date; export; read-only for all roles |

# 15. Product Roadmap

| Phase | Timeline | Deliverables | Exit criteria |
|---|---|---|---|
| Phase 1: Prototype | Weeks 1 to 8 | Login with simulated OTP; dashboard; scoring engine; ten dummy profiles; four renewal flows; admin panel | Demonstrable end to end on dummy data; all Must have stories accepted |
| Phase 2: Pilot readiness | Months 3 to 6 | Real SMS OTP; consent manager; security review; Hindi and Gujarati; provider sandbox integrations | Penetration test passed; legal review of discount model completed |
| Phase 3: Limited pilot | Months 6 to 12 | Live VAHAN and eChallan data for a selected region; live insurer and PUC partners; live payments | Regulator approval in writing; pilot KPIs met for 90 days |
| Phase 4: Scale | Months 12 to 24 | Multi-state rollout; fleet accounts; analytics product for insurers; mobile app | Uptime and support targets met across two states |

# 16. Success Metrics and KPIs

| KPI | Definition | Prototype target | Pilot target |
|---|---|---|---|
| Activation rate | Users who log in and view their score within the first session | Demo: 100% | 70% or more |
| Score understanding | Users who open the score ledger at least once in 30 days | Not measured | 40% or more |
| On-time challan payment | Share of challans paid by the due date among active users | Not measured | Improve by 15% over baseline |
| Renewal completion | Started renewals that reach a successful transaction | Demo flow works | 85% or more |
| Transaction success rate | Successful transactions divided by attempted transactions | Simulated | 98% or more |
| Fee revenue per 1,000 transactions | Sum of platform fees divided by transaction count | Tracked in admin | Tracked against plan |
| Score distribution health | Share of users in Fair, Good and Very Good | Shown in admin | Balanced across categories |

# 17. Risks and Dependencies

| Risk or dependency | Impact | Likelihood | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|---|
| Discount model requires regulatory or scheme approval | High | High | Keep discounts configurable; launch only with written approval |
| Insurance discounts may conflict with IRDAI product rules | High | Medium | Legal review before pilot; work with insurers as principal sellers |
| PAN and personal data misuse | High | Medium | Encryption, masking, minimisation, consent logs and DPDP compliance |
| Dependency on VAHAN and eChallan API access | High | High | Prototype uses dummy data; integration treated as separate workstream |
| Score perceived as unfair by users | Medium | Medium | Ledger transparency, appeal path, decay and caps |
| Wrong challan data leads to wrong score | Medium | Medium | Dispute workflow; nightly reconciliation; recalculation tools |
| Fraud through fake documents | Medium | Medium | Verification of documents at source in production phases |
| Provider reluctance to share fee | Medium | Medium | Clear value proposition; configurable fee mode |
| SMS OTP delays or DLT registration | Medium | Medium | Register early; support alternate channels |

# 18. Assumptions and Constraints

## 18.1 Assumptions

The prototype assumes that users provide their own mobile number and PAN, and that the dummy data stands in for the data that would come from authorised sources. It assumes that discount percentages can be set by configuration, and that participating providers will accept a discounted amount with the government-funded portion settled separately. It assumes that the scoring model can be explained in plain language without revealing the proprietary weights in full.

### 18.2 Constraints

The prototype must not use real government databases, real personal data or live payment gateways. No real PAN may appear anywhere in the prototype. The scoring model must comply with the principle that a single violation does not automatically destroy a score. Configuration changes must be audited. Development is limited to the React, Node.js, Express and PostgreSQL stack defined in the TRD.

## 19. Open Decisions for Stakeholders

The following questions need a decision before the production phase. The prototype proceeds with the default assumption shown in each row.

| Question | Default assumption in prototype |
|---|---|
| Who pays the platform fee: the provider or the user? | Provider pays; user payable is unchanged |
| Is the government-funded discount settled to the provider in advance or in arrears? | Simulated as settled at the point of transaction |
| Are Fair category users allowed to renew through VAI? | Yes, at full price with the same breakdown |
| How long before a violation stops affecting the score entirely? | No hard cutoff; decay half-life of one year |
| Is an appeal available for score changes? | Yes, via a dispute reference reviewed by an admin |
| Which fee option is the default at launch? | Option A, 0.005% |